

transferring pictures, except that they also charge the camera. USB offers fairly decent transfer speeds, although large data (read as 8 GB plus) might send you off to make some coffee while the transfer completes.

Firewire, on the other hand, is like a big brother to USB. It generally outperforms USB 2.0 in terms of transfer speeds and reliability. Hence, Firewire is a common connection these days for high-end digital cameras and camcorders. The interface is also known by the proprietary brand names such as FireWire (Apple Inc.), i.LINK (Sony), and Lynx (Texas Instruments), while its technical nomenclature is IEEE 1394. Transferring via Firewire is similar to USB. Locate the Firewire port on your computer. It resembles a wider USB port. There are basically three types of Firewire connections: Firewire 400, Firewire 800 and Firewire S800T. All three are shaped slightly differently. However, adapters are available. If your camera supports Firewire, you probably have the cable bundled along with it. Plug one end of the Firewire cable that came with your digital camera into the Firewire port, and plug the other end into your camera. The rest is exactly as with USB.



9.2 Bluetooth / WLAN

The beauty of Bluetooth is that there is no need for cables, plugs, and all the precarious bending and reaching out behind the PC for sockets; not to mention less clutter of wires on and around your desk. Many printers, cameras, and laptops these days, come with Bluetooth connectivity. This allows you to print wirelessly and transfer pictures. To begin with, ensure that both devices are Bluetooth enabled. To switch on Bluetooth navigate the interface menu (usually LCD) of both the printer and camera and select the appropriate option. Next, pair both the devices. This can be done from either of the devices but it's best if done from the sending device, ie. your camera. Once the devices are paired, it's as simple as sending files via a Bluetooth phone. So, after the pros, let's look at the cons. Bluetooth, though convenient, does have its share of hassles. Transfer speeds are abysmally slow. So for all practical